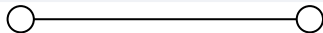


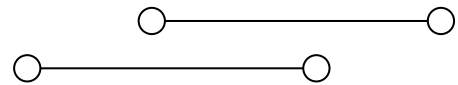


# WatMatch

**Creating Canada's Largest Capstone Ecosystem**

Siddharth, Samson, Ayman, Darsh, Sparsh

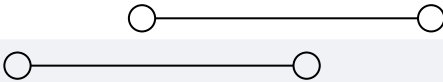




# Creating Canada's Largest Capstone Ecosystem

- Global Futures Initiative (more info [here](#))
- Our contacts:
  - Prof. Derek Rayside (Initiative Lead, Mentor)
  - Mr. Jamieson Cox (Centre for Work-Integrated Learning)
- We're first rolling out this initiative to UWaterloo students
- Long-term vision: accessible to all Canadian Universities





✦ 01 ✦

# Problem Recap



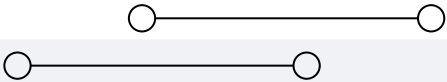
# Manual Matching Work

Current cross-faculty matching depends on large PDFs built from student survey responses

## 4 main problems

1. Students cannot easily search/compare opportunities
2. Most students form teams with people they already know
3. Faculty/staff coordinate matching by hand
4. No clear system of record for consent, approvals, or decisions for interdisciplinary matching





✦ 02 ✦

# Why this matters



# Who does this impact?

A platform for capstone matching helps...

## **Students**

Find teammates, projects, external opportunities beyond their own network!

## **Instructors**

Review proposals, give feedback, manage teams, track decisions in one centralized roster!

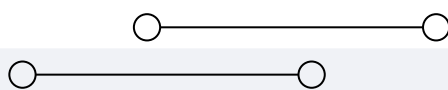
## **External Partners**

Share opportunities and ideas with students!

## **Universities**

To support interdisciplinary capstones at a large scale





✦ 03 ✦

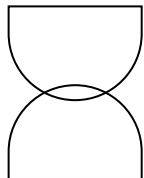
# Mid 2 Status





# Mid 2 - Technical Design Decisions

| Decision                                                                                                 | Alternative Rejected                                                                                    | Reason                                                                                        |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Capstone Leader proposes the final team roster                                                           | Ranking engine, auto-enrollment                                                                         | <b>Stakeholders:</b> selection rules will vary by course                                      |
| “exploration phase” where interests/invites <b>aren’t official</b> membership (until “commitment phase”) | Interests/invites are official membership by default, student locked into working on at most 1 capstone | <b>Stakeholders:</b> wanted it to feel more like a “marketplace” first, then form rigid teams |
| Multiple <b>instructor review states</b> (approved, changes_requested, etc...)                           | Single approval boolean                                                                                 | <b>Stakeholders:</b> instructors to have power to express different forms of changes          |
| <b>Database RPCs</b>                                                                                     | Multiple Independent client-side writes                                                                 | <b>Transactionality:</b> operations must succeed/fail together                                |
| Instructor dashboard scoped around <b>one course roster</b> + teams + “attention” items                  | Global instructor (admin-like) dashboard with granular power                                            | <b>Instructor feedback:</b> Kami suggested mimicking Piazza & Crowdmark’s pattern             |







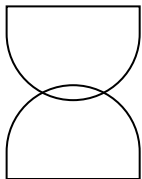
# Mid 2 - Initial Rollout



Mid 2 - Past Capstones WatMatch - <https://watmatch.vercel.app/>

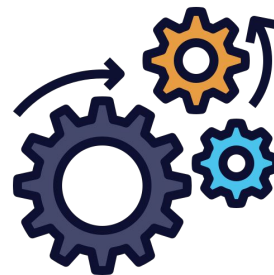
UWaterloo students can browse publicly scraped past capstones + shortlist for inspiration

- Students want to see current opportunities, and want visibility into ongoing capstones
- Filter by themes/niches like AI, health, robotics, RF, distributed systems, etc...
- Show member profiles with more detail (experience, linkedin, github, etc...)
- Richer capstone archives (presentation photos, docs, project artifacts)
- Record shortlist notes on “why I saved a capstone & what idea I want to borrow from it”
- Search highlighting + share/export a shortlist link with teammates



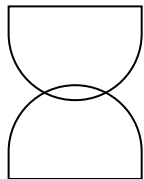
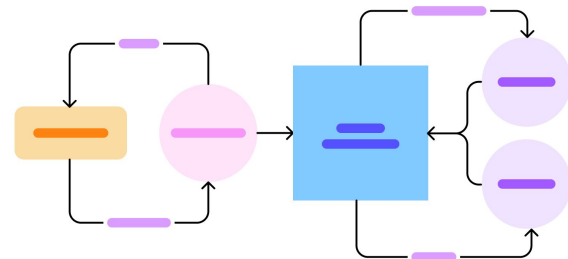


# Mid 2 - Implementation



## Mid 2 - Single-Course WatMatch + Mentors + External Partners

- ❑ Feature #3: Let students create team without capstone
- ❑ Feature #4: Leaders can **invite** students; students can express **interest** in teams/capstones
- ❑ Feature #5: Instructor Accept/Reject/Request Changes
- ❑ Feature #6: Student's revision & resubmissions
- ❑ Feature #7: Introduce capstone **mentors**
- ❑ Feature #8: Introduce **external partner** opportunities
- ❑ Feature #9: Enhance student profile creation
- ❑ More redesigned Figma Diagrams
- ❑ Create demo\_seed.sql seed for manual testing





# Mid 2 - WatMatch GitLab

Open 4 Closed 0 All 4

Pitch Siddharth Viswanath / WatMatch

May 11, 2026–May 28, 2026 Expired

3/3 complete 100%



Mid 1 Siddharth Viswanath / WatMatch

May 30, 2026–Jun 9, 2026 Expired

7/7 complete 100%



Mid 2 Siddharth Viswanath / WatMatch

Jun 13, 2026–Jul 7, 2026 Expired

15/15 complete 100%



Final Siddharth Viswanath / WatMatch

Jul 11, 2026–Aug 1, 2026 Open

0/0 complete 0%



Jul 11, 2026

Add Stakeholder Meeting Docs

Sist279 authored 24 minutes ago

a8dd678

Jul 3, 2026

Rename Mid 1 Slides

Siddharth Viswanath authored 1 week ago

185e87d9

Upload Mid 1 Presentation

Siddharth Viswanath authored 1 week ago

bf71573a

Merge branch 'docs/mid2-meetings' into 'main'

Siddharth Viswanath authored 1 week ago

fb813b45

Docs: Update Mid 2 Meeting Notes

WatMatch authored 1 week ago

cd744e78

Jun 27, 2026

Merge branch 'docs/mid2-flow-diagrams' into 'main'

Siddharth Viswanath authored 1 week ago

b98bce71

Flow Diagrams

Sist279 authored 2 weeks ago

135818fc

Merge branch 'chore/mid2-foundation-schema-demo' into 'main'

Siddharth Viswanath authored 2 weeks ago

fd1567a5

Mid 2: Foundation schema and demo seed

WatMatch authored 2 weeks ago

baeaf089

Merge branch 'feat/mid2-profile-team-formation' into 'main'

Siddharth Viswanath authored 2 weeks ago

58dbcf4

Mid 2: Student profiles for team formation

WatMatch authored 2 weeks ago

67418119

Mid 2: Student profiles for team formation

WatMatch authored 2 weeks ago

67418119

Merge branch 'feat/mid2-team-workspace' into 'main'

Siddharth Viswanath authored 2 weeks ago

47d8a6d2

Mid 2: Team workspace before capstone submission

WatMatch authored 2 weeks ago

8f2a2809

Merge branch 'feat/mid2-marketplace-exploration' into 'main'

Siddharth Viswanath authored 2 weeks ago

b1d7815d

Mid 2: Marketplace invites and interest flow

WatMatch authored 2 weeks ago

ad64ce88

Merge branch 'feat/mid2-review-resubmission' into 'main'

Siddharth Viswanath authored 2 weeks ago

9ddcf1fa

Mid 2: Instructor review and resubmission loop

WatMatch authored 2 weeks ago

3d7657f5

Merge branch 'feat/mid2-mentor-partner-opportunities' into 'main'

Siddharth Viswanath authored 2 weeks ago

ebf7d416

Mid 2: Mentor and external partner demo flows

WatMatch authored 2 weeks ago

c8e94323

Merge branch 'test/mid2-demo-ga-unhappy-paths' into 'main'

Siddharth Viswanath authored 2 weeks ago

ad848277

Mid 2: Demo seed and unhappy-path QA notes

WatMatch authored 2 weeks ago

32547fbc

Closed

26

Docs: Update Mid 2 Meeting Notes

docs

#26 Mid 2

Design: Redesign Mid 2 Flow Diagrams

design docs in progress

#23 Mid 2

Bookmarks: Save Past and Current Capstones

backend database feature frontend in progress

#21 Mid 2

Past Capstones App: Standalone Deployment

docs feature frontend in progress

#22 Mid 2

Student Profiles: Team Formation Upgrade

backend feature frontend

#13 Mid 2

Teams: Create Team Without Capstone

backend database feature frontend

#14 Mid 2

Marketplace: Students Express Interest in Teams/Capstones

backend feature frontend

#16 Mid 2

Marketplace: Leader Invites Students

backend feature frontend

#15 Mid 2

Capstone Submission: Revision and Resubmission Flow

backend feature frontend

#18 Mid 2

Instructor Review: Accept, Reject, Request Changes

backend feature frontend

#17 Mid 2



# Mid 2 - Meeting with Feedback Team

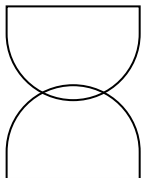


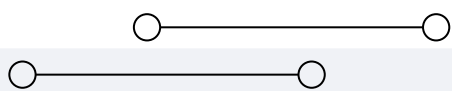
Every Sunday (10AM-12PM)

Mid 2 Meetings: 06/07, 06/14, 06/21, 06/28, 07/05

Suggestions from Team:

- **Ben:** Track whether approved WatMatch course change was actually completed in Quest.
- **Lexie:** Explore better separation of Mentor, External Partner, etc... roles & permissions
- **Adib:** Mid-stage vision, add project milestones where mentors can track progress
- **Andrew:** Let teams advertise “missing skills/roles” for interdisciplinary capstones





✦ 04 ✦

# Mid 2 Demo





# Mid 2 - Meeting with Stakeholders

[07/09] Meeting with **Prof. Derek Rayside** and **Mr. Jamieson Cox**

## What I presented

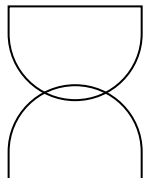
- Marketplace Design: exploration → commitment → finalization → term turnover
- New roles: Mentor, Academic Advisor, Enrollment Coordinator
- Initial rollout of past capstones app + feedback received from students

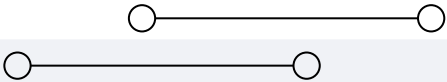
## Feedback

- Rename: Mentor → University Mentor; Academic Advisor → Community Mentor
- Add an optional University Relationship Manager (only for [FCI capstones](#), this is rare)
- Interdisciplinary routing: Arts teammate → ARTS 450, Eng teammate → GENE 403

## Requests made to Prof. Rayside

- Pushed again for VM allocation from IST / ENG Computing (blocker for UW ADFS auth)
- Requested them to share the initial rollout with their network of students/staff





05

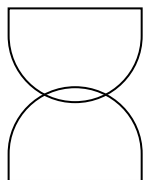
Plan to  
Final





# SE 490 - Plan to Final

- **Final** - Multi-Course, Interdisciplinary WatMatch
- Feature #10: Audit log for capstone lifecycle
- Feature #11: Multi-Course WatMatch
  - Academic advisor / enrollment coordinator roles + workflows
  - Cross-course: SE student wants to work on ECE capstone => switch into ECE 498A
- Feature #12: Interdisciplinary routing ([Future Cities](#), [Global Engagement](#), GENE/SCI/ARTS)
- Feature #13: Marketplace Phase Implementation
  - 3 Phases: Exploration → commitment → finalization
  - Shared for interdisciplinary, Instructor-based for regular
- Feature #14: Term turnovers (SE 490 → SE 491)
- Feature #15: WatMatch-based capstones → Past Capstones
- Stakeholder Feedback: Rename roles, segregate responsibilities & permissions of each role







# Thank You

We'd love to hear your thoughts!

